

Xinyuan Yang

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🌐 <https://xinyuanyang.github.io>

Education

American University

PhD in Political Science

Sept 2022 – Present

- **Research Area** Political Methodology, Computational Social Science, Comparative Politics
- **Committee** Jeff Gill (Chair), Tongtong Zhang, Ryan T. Moore, Gary King (External)

Harvard University *Visiting Graduate Student, Teaching Fellow*

Sept 2024 – May 2025

American University

MS in Data Analytics

Sept 2020 – May 2022

University of Wisconsin - Madison

BA in Political Science

Sept 2015 – May 2019

Research Interests

- Political Methodology: Bayesian Nonparametric Model, Spatial Temporal Model, Survey Methodology, Machine Learning
- Comparative Politics: Conflict, Political Economy

Selected Work in Progress

1. A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Framework for Predicting Conflict Intensity (under review at Political Analysis)
Xinyuan Yang
2. How Does Chinese Foreign Development Finance Incite Conflict in Sub-Saharan Africa
Xinyuan Yang
3. A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data (under review)
Xinyuan Yang, Jeff Gill
4. Dynamic Contrastive Contextual Embedding for Ideal Points Estimation
Yuki Mikiya (Keio University), Kentaro Nakamura (Harvard University), **Xinyuan Yang**
5. Predicting Public Opinion Towards China in the U.S. using Bayesian Spatiotemporal Kriging Model
Xinyuan Yang, Michael Cerny (Harvard University)

Conferences

A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. American Political Science Association (APSA)

September (Scheduled), 2026

A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. 2026 International Symposium on Spatiotemporal Data Science

August (Scheduled), 2026

A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. Polmeth 2026

July, 2026

A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data. Southern Political Science Association Annual Conference

January, 2026

A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data. Latin American Political Methodology Annual Meeting

November, 2025

Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Prediction of Conflict in Sub Saharan Africa. Polmeth 2025

July, 2025

Grant and Scholarships

AY2026-2027 SPA PhD Student Funding Award	<i>\$28000</i>
Polmeth Travel Grant 2025	<i>\$500</i>
Neil and Ann Kerwin Doctoral Fellowship 2025	<i>\$10000</i>
EITM Certificate Scholarship Summer 2023	
Kogod School of Business Merit Scholarship 2020 - 2021	<i>\$15000</i>

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant	<i>American University</i>
<i>STAT-616/GOVT-696 Generalized Linear Model</i>	<i>Spring 2026</i>
<i>STAT-618/GOVT-618 Bayesian Statistics</i>	<i>Fall 2025</i>
Teaching Fellow	<i>Harvard University</i>
<i>GOV 2017 Applied Bayesian Statistics for the Social Sciences</i>	<i>Spring 2025</i>
<i>GOV 2003: Quantitative Social Science Methods, II</i>	<i>Fall 2024</i>

Professional Services

Political Analysis Replication Analyst	<i>Fall 2023 – Summer 2024</i>
<i>Editorial Assistant</i>	<i>Fall 2022 – Summer 2024</i>
Center for Data Science Graduate Student Fellow	<i>Fall 2022 – Present</i>
Spring Methodology Reading Group 2024 , American University <i>Graduate Coordinator</i>	<i>Spring 2024</i>
Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) , Harvard University <i>Graduate Student Fellow</i>	<i>Fall 2024 – Present</i>
IQSS Applied Statistics Workshop , Harvard University <i>Graduate Coordinator</i>	<i>Fall 2024 – Spring 2025</i>

Skills

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), German (Limited Working)

Programming: R, Python, JAGS (MCMC), LaTeX, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, Stata, SQL